

- Through tours in rural areas, he established direct contact with ordinary people and talked about their concerns in the language which they understood. This was a novel political technique; it had never been practiced by the educated leaders of the congress.
- For the first time, the peasants were drawn into political agitation under a new type of leadership.
- For the first time in India, Gandhi was displaying that magnetic personality, which was to draw multitudes to him and to earn him the title of Mahatma and the nickname of Bapu. Under pressure from the Government of India, the Government of Bihar appointed a committee of enquiry (June, 1917). The recommendations of the committee were implemented, by the Champaran Agrarian Act of 1917. He was also member of this committee.
- Some of leaders associated with Gandhiji in this Satyagraha were JB Kripalani, Rajendra Prasad, Mahadev Desai, Narhari Parikh etc.
- Based on this movement, a book *Neel Darpan* was written by Dinbandhu Mitra.

Ahmedabad Satyagraha (1918)

- While Gandhiji was still engaged in his task in Bihar, he received a letter from Shrimati Anasuyabai. She informed him about the condition of workers in Ahmedabad mills and requested him to take up their cause with the mill owners.
- The terrible plague of 1917-18, led to a heavy decline in the number of workers in the major industrial city of Ahmedabad. In order to attract the workers, the mill owners started paying them 75% of their wages as plague bonus.
- The mill-owners declaration of locking out the mills on 22nd February, 1918 made the situation even more serious. At last, the issue was resolved with the intervention of Mahatma Gandhi. The mill owners agreed to give 35% of wages as bonus. This offer was accepted by the workers.
- Gandhiji intervened in a dispute between the workers and mill owners and he took a fast unto death to force a compromise.

Kheda Satyagraha (1918)

- It was first Non-Cooperation Movement in India. In 1917 most of the kharif crops of the farmers of Kheda district in Gujarat were destroyed due to heavy rains thus, incapacitating them to pay the land revenue to the government. When the government refused to comply with the peasant's demand to remit the land revenues, Gandhiji advised them to withhold the payment and launch a struggle against the government on 22nd March, 1918.
- Gandhiji with his lieutenants like Vallabhbhai Patel, the young lawyer of Kheda (who had become Gandhiji's follower during this Satyagraha), Indulal Yagnik and many other youth, toured villages to encourage the peasants.

Home Rule Leagues (1916)

- Home Rule Leagues having been inspired by the Irish rebellion, Mrs Annie Besant (September, 1916) and BG Tilak (April, 1916) set-up the Home Rule League.
- BG Tilak linked up Swaraj with the demand for the formation of linguistic states and education in Vernacular language. Tilak gave the popular slogan, "Freedom is my birth right and I shall have it."

Lucknow Pact (1916)

The Lucknow session of the INC in 1916 was memorable event on account of two important development. First was re-admission of the extremists who had been expelled from the INC 9 years earlier. The second development was the alliance between the Congress and Muslim League.

Rowlatt Act (1919)

The government passed the Rowlatt Act in March 1919, which empowered the British Government to detain any person without trial. The act was a serious betrayal of the promises made by the government during the world war period.

Jallianwala Bagh Tragedy (1919)

- People were agitating against arrest of their popular leaders **Dr Saif-ud-din Kitchlew** and **Dr Satyapal**.
- On 13th April, 1919, Baisakhi Day, hundreds of people were massacred and several thousand wounded in Jallianwala Bagh where they had assembled to held a protest meeting against the repressive policies of the government.
- The troops led by General Dyer opened fire on the unarmed men and women, young and old, Hindu and Muslim. It was regarded as the worst massacre during the entire freedom struggle. **Hunter Commission** was appointed to enquire into it.
- Sardar Udham Singh killed General Dyer on 13th March, 1940, when the latter was addressing a meeting in Caxton hall in London.

The Khilafat Movement (1920-22)

The All India Khilafat Conference held at Delhi in November, 1919. Gandhiji was the head of Khilafat Committee. Maulana Abul Kalam Azad also led the movement. Later a Khilafat Manifesto was published which called upon the British to protect the Khalifa (Caliphate).

Non-Cooperation Movement (1920-22)

- The Non-Cooperation Movement under the leadership of Mahatma Gandhi, *was launched to press three main demands*
 - i. The Khilafat issue.
 - ii. The redressal of the Punjab wrongs.
 - iii. The attainment of Swaraj.

- *The programme of the movement had two main aspects*
 - i. Destructive
 - ii. Constructive
- *Under the first category came*
 - Surrender of titles and honorary offices and resignation from nominated seats in local bodies.
 - Refusal to attend official functions.
 - Gradual withdrawal of children from officially controlled schools and colleges.
 - Boycott of British Courts by lawyers and litigants.
 - Refusal on the part of the military, clerical and labour classes to offer themselves as recruits for service in Mesopotamia.
 - Boycott the elections to the Legislative Council.
 - Boycott of the foreign goods.
- *Under the second category came*
 - Use of Swadeshi goods.
 - Hand spinning and weaving.
 - Removal of social evils like casteism and untouchability.
 - Hindu-Muslim unity.
 - Collection of money for Tilak Swaraj fund.
 - Setting up national educational institutions.
- The Prince of Wales visited India during this period.

Chauri Chaura Incident (1922)

- In Chauri Chaura (Near Gorakhpur, Uttar Pradesh), a police station including 22 policemen was burnt on 5th February, 1922. On 12th February, 1922, Gandhiji decided to withdraw the Non-Cooperation Movement.
- Most of the nationalist leaders including CR Das, Motilal Nehru, Subhash Chandra Bose, Jawaharlal Nehru, however, expressed their bewilderment at Gandhi's decision to withdraw the Non-Cooperation Movement on 12th February, 1922. In March 1922, Gandhiji was arrested and sentenced for 6 years in jail.

The Swarajya Party (1923)

- CR Das, Motilal Nehru and NC Kelkar suggested that instead of boycotting the councils, they should enter and expose them.
- In December 1922, Das and Motilal Nehru formed the Congress Khilafat Swarajya Party with CR Das as the President and Motilal Nehru as one of the secretaries.
- The Swarajists contested elections to the Legislative Assembly and Provincial Councils. In 1923, elections they got 42 seats out of 101 elected seats in Bengal and Central Province. The party broke in 1926 after the death of CR Das.

Simon Commission (1927)

- In November 1927, the British Government appointed the Indian Statutory Commission known as the Simon Commission (after the name of Chairman).
- John Simon, a British politician, was appointed as Chairman of the commission to review the situation in India with a view to introduce further reforms and extension of parliamentary democracy.
- At Madras Session in 1927 presided over by Dr Ansari, the Indian National Congress decided to boycott the commission.
- The police came down heavily on demonstrators. The **lathi-charge** at Lahore, led to the death of Lala Lajpat Rai because of injuries (30th October, 1928).
- The agenda for the second round table conference held in London was to discuss the report of Simon Commission.

Bardoli Movement (1928)

- Bardoli Movement against the payment of land tax led by Vallabhbhai Patel in a village called Bardoli in Gujarat.
- Vallabhbhai Patel got the title **Sardar** from the women of this movement.

The Nehru Report (1928)

- Having boycotted the Simon Commission, the Indian political parties tried to hammer out a common political programme.
- All parties conference met in February, 1928 and appointed a sub-committee under the chairmanship of Motilal Nehru to draft a Constitution. This was the first major attempt by the Indians to draft a constitutional framework for the country.
- The committee also included Tej Bahadur Sapru. The report was finalised on August, 1928.

Other Political Parties and Movements (1922-27)

- The moderates who had walked out of the INC in 1918, formed National Liberal League, later known as the **All India Liberal Federation** and cooperated with the government.
- The All India Khilafat Committee also ceased to function after the abolition of Khilafat in Turkey by Mustafa Kamal Pasha in 1924.
- The **Hindu Mahasabha**, a communal organisation of the Hindus, founded in December 1915, also gained strength and Madan Mohan Malaviya was elected as its President at Belgaum Session.

Revolutionary Movements

Hindustan Republic Association

- In October 1924, a meeting of revolutionaries from all parts of India was called at Kanpur. This meeting was attended by old revolutionary leaders like Sachindranath Sanyal, Jogesh Chandra Chatterjee and Ram Prasad Bismil and also by some new revolutionaries like Bhagat Singh, Shiv Verma, Sukhdev, Bhagwati Charan Vohra and Chandra Shekhar Azad.
- At this meeting, it was decided to set-up the Hindustan Republican Association which was later recognised as the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA). The HSRA was founded at Kanpur in October, 1924 by Sachindra Nath Sanyal, Jogesh Chandra Chatterjee, Ramprasad Bismil and Chandra Shekhar Azad and declared its objectives.

Kakori Conspiracy Case

- Revolutionaries decided to commit a dacoity in a running train on 9th August, 1925 at Kakori on the Lucknow-Saharanpur section of the Northern railway. 29 arrested and tried in the Kakori Conspiracy Case.
- Four revolutionaries Ram Prasad Bismil, Ashfaqullah Khan, Roshan Lal and Rajendra Lahiri were sentenced to death.

Saundars's Murder

- The first revolutionary act of the HSRA was the murder of Mr Saundars, the Assistant Superintendent of Police, Lahore, who had ordered Lathi-charge and brutally wounded Lala Lajpat Rai during Anti-Simon Commission protest march at Lahore on 17th December, 1928.
- Saundars was killed at Lahore railway station on 30th October, 1928 by Bhagat Singh, Chandra Shekhar Azad and Rajguru.

Bomb at Legislative Assembly

- Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt threw two crude bombs in Central Legislative Assembly on 8th April, 1929, when assembly was discussing the Public Safety Bill and the Trade Disputes Bill.
- Bhagat Singh and Dutt were arrested and tried in Central Assembly Bomb Case. Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev and Rajguru were hanged to death on 23rd March, 1931 at Lahore jail for their role in Saundars's murder case.

Chittagong Armoury Raid

Surya Sen (1930), a revolutionary of Bengal masterminded the raid on Chittagong armoury. He was hanged in 1933. On 27th February, 1931 Chandra Shekhar Azad was surrounded by the police at Alfred Park, Allahabad where he shot himself dead.

Movements After Simon Commission

Lahore Session or Poorna Swaraj (1929)

- On 19th December, 1929, under the Presidentship of Pandit JL Nehru, the Lahore Session of the Congress gave voice to the new militant spirit. It passed a resolution declaring Poorna Swaraj (complete independence) to be the Congress objective.
- On 31st December, 1929 the newly adopted tri-colour flag of freedom was hoisted. On 26th January, 1930, it was fixed as the first Independence Day, which was to be celebrated every year.

The Civil Disobedience Movement

The Civil Disobedience Movement was started by Gandhiji on 12th March, 1930 with his famous Dandi March.

Dandi March

Mahatma Gandhi launched the Salt Satyagraha on 12th March, 1930. Gandhiji marched from his Sabarmati Ashram (Ahmedabad) with 78 followers. After 24 days long march, he symbolically broke the Salt Law at Dandi on 6th April, 1930. The breaking of the Salt Laws formally inaugurated the Civil Disobedience Movement. This movement sparked off patriotism also among the Indian soldiers in British Army. The Garhwali soldiers refused to open fire on the people of Peshawar.

First Round Table Conference

(12th November, 1930– January 1931)

The First Round Table Conference was held in London. 57 political leaders from India participated the conference. Congress didn't participate.

Gandhi-Irwin Pact

In March 1931, the famous Gandhi-Irwin Pact was signed. Gandhi was appointed as the representative of the Congress of the Second Round Table Conference.

Second Round Table Conference

(1st September - 1st December, 1931)

The Second Round Table Conference opened in September, 1931 in London. Gandhiji represented the INC and went to London to meet British PM Ramsay MacDonald. Indian National Congress in 1932 was declared an illegal organisation. British Government also refused to concede the basic nationalist demand for freedom on the basis of immediate grant of dominion status.

The Communal Award (16th August, 1932)

Prime Minister Ramsay MacDonald announced his 'Communal Award' on 16th August, 1932. According to this award, the Muslim, European and Sikh voters would elect their candidates by voting in separate communal electorates. The award declared the depressed class (Scheduled caste of today) also to be Minority Community entitled to separate electorate and thus, separated them from the rest of the Hindus.

Poona Pact (25th September, 1932)

- Gandhiji started his fast unto death in Yeravada jail near Poona, on 25th September, 1932. He wanted the Communal Award to be withdrawn. The Poona Pact according to which the idea of separate electorates for the depressed classes was abandoned, but the seats reserved for them in the provincial legislatures were increased from 71 in the Award to 147 and in the Central Legislature to 18% of the total.
- Poona Pact agreed upon to appoint electorate for upper and lower classes. Upliftment of harijan now became Gandhi's main concern. He started an **All India Anti-Untouchability League** in September, 1932 and the weekly *Harijan* in January, 1933 even before his release. 8th January, 1933 was observed a 'Temple Entry Day'.
- After the Poona Pact, Mahatma Gandhi lost interest in the Civil Disobedience Movement and fully engrossed in the Anti-Untouchability Movement, which led to the foundation of the Harijan Sevak Sangh.

Third Round Table Conference (1932)

Held from 24th November to December, 1932. The Congress boycotted it and only 46 delegates attended the session.

Lahore Resolution of League

- In 1940 at the Lahore, a resolution called for independent state for Muslims i.e. Pakistan, which was totally based on the Two-Nation Theory of Muslim League.
- The term Pakistan had been coined by Choudhary Rahmat Ali in his Pakistan Declaration in 1933. He referred to the names of the five northern regions of the British India namely; Punjab, Afghanistan, Kashmir, Sindh and Baluchistan.

Demand for Pakistan

- In March, 1940 at the Lahore, demand for Pakistan was called. The session was chaired by Muhammad Ali Jinnah.
- The Muslim League demanded that the areas in which the Muslims are numerically in a majority as in the North-Western and Eastern Zones of India should be grouped to constitute Independent states.
- The Muslim League was encouraged by the British Government to press its demand for a separate state.

- The demand for a separate state was opposed by Congress and large sections of Muslims such as, Maulana Abul Kalam Azad, Khan Abdul Gaffar Khan and others.

The Individual Satyagrahas

- There were two opinions in Congress about the launching of civil disobedience. Gandhi felt that the atmosphere was not in favour of civil disobedience as there were differences and indiscipline within the Congress. While some leaders of Congress, socialists and the All India Kisan Sabha were in favour of immediate struggle.
- The August Offer had disillusioned the Congress. Finally, Gandhiji had a long meeting with the Viceroy at Simla in September, 1940, after which he was convinced that the British would not modify their policy in India.
- He therefore, decided to launch **Individual Satyagraha**. The aim of the satyagraha was to disprove the British claim of India supporting the war effort wholeheartedly.
- On 17th October, 1940, **Acharya Vinoba Bhave** (*the first Satyagrahi*) inaugurated the satyagraha by delivering an anti-war speech at Paunar; Bhave had been personally selected by Gandhiji for this.
- Mahatma Gandhi suspended it on 17th December, 1940 due to little enthusiasm it created. Jawaharlal Nehru was the second to offer Satyagraha after Vinoba Bhave. It was during Individual Satyagraha that Gandhi declared Nehru as his chosen successor. Individual Satyagraha was also known as **Delhi Chalo Satyagraha**.

August Offer (1940)

- To get Indian cooperation in the war effort the viceroy announced the August Offer (August 1940), which proposed dominion status as the objective for India, expansion of viceroy's Executive Council, setting up of a Constituent Assembly would frame the Constitution after war according to their social, economic and political conceptions.
- Subject to fulfillment of obligation of the government regarding defence, minority rights treaties with states. All India Services and no future Constitution to be adopted without the consent of minorities. The Congress rejected the August Offer, but it was accepted by the Muslim League.

Cripps Mission (1942)

- In March 1942, when Japan occupied Rangoon, after having overrun almost the whole of South-East Asia.
- The British Government, with a view to get support from India, sent Sir Stafford Cripps, leader of the House of Commons to settle terms with the Indian leaders.

- For the first time, through the Cripps Mission, British Government recognised the Right of Dominion for India. The mission promised for fulfillment of past promises to 'self government' of Indian people.
- The Indian leaders refused to accept more promise for the future and Gandhiji told the proposals as a post-dated cheque on a crashing bank.

The Quit India Movement (1942)

- Also known as proposal and leaderless revolt. The Congress met at Bombay on 8th August, 1942 and passed the famous Quit India Resolution. Gandhiji gave the slogan '**Do or Die.**'
- The Quit India Movement became a powerful mass campaign galvanising people into vehemently demanding freedom from the British rule.
- On 9th August, 1942, Gandhiji and other Congress leaders were arrested and the Congress party was declared illegal once again.
- The violence had broken out in different parts of the country. Many government offices were destroyed, telegraph wires were cut and communication paralysed.
- Mahatma Gandhi disclaimed all responsibilities for the violence which was the consequence of repressive measure taken by the British. The parallel government was set-up in Ballia in Eastern Uttar Pradesh, by **Chittu Pandey**.
- The movement was finally crushed. Span of the movement was short lived, but the importance of the movement lay in demonstrating the intensity of the nationalist feeling that people displayed and the extent to which people would go to make sacrifices in order to achieve freedom.
- The Muslim League did not support the Quit India Movement. Achyut Patwardhan, Ram Manohar Lohia, Jayaprakash Narayan and Aruna Asaf Ali were the movement's leaders.

The Indian National Army (INA)

- The Indian National Army led by Subhash Chandra Bose was in cooperation with the Japanese.
- Subhash Chandra Bose, after founding the Forward Bloc, in January 1941, escaped from India and went to Berlin (Germany) *via* Moscow.
- Subhash Chandra Bose, who had escaped from his confinement in Calcutta in 1941 formed the Indian National Army in 1943, in Singapore, along with Rasbehari Bose.
- The **Azad Hind Fauj** as the INA was aimed at a military campaign for the liberation of India. The INA consisted mostly of Indian soldiers of the British Army who had taken prisoners by the Japanese after they had conquered the British colonies in South-East Asia.

- INA had three fighting brigades named Gandhi, Azad and Nehru. Even a women's regiment named the Rani Jhansi Regiment was formed.
- In July 1944, Subhash Chandra Bose asked for Gandhi's blessings for India's last war of independence. Subhash Chandra Bose who was now called Netaji by the soldiers of the INA gave his followers the battle cry of '*Jai Hind*'. Subhash Chandra Bose also gave the slogan '*Dilli Chalo*'.
- The last echo of the INA Movement was heard when the INA prisoners were tried at the Red Fort in Delhi and were defended by a panel of lawyers which included Tej Bahadur Sapru, Bhulabhai Desai and Jawaharlal Nehru.
- Rangoon and Singapore were the two INA headquarters.
- 12th November, 1945 was celebrated as the INA Day.

Towards the Dominion States

Rajagopalachari Formula

- C Rajagopalachari (CR) the veteran Congress leader, prepared a formula for Congress-League Cooperation. It was an acceptance of the league's demand for Pakistan. *The main points in CR plan were as follows*
 - Muslim League to endorse Congress demand for independence.
 - League to cooperate with Congress in forming a provisional government at centre.
 - After the end of the war, the entire population and Muslim majority areas in the North-West and North-East of India decide by plebiscite.
 - In case of acceptance of partition agreement to be made jointly for safeguarding defence, commerce communication etc.
 - The above terms to be operative only if England transferred full powers to India.
- Jinnah wanted the Congress to accept the *Two Nation Theory*. He wanted only the Muslim of North-West and North-East to vote in the plebiscite and not the entire population. Hindu leaders led by **VD Savarkar** condemned the CR Plan.

Wavell Plan and Shimla Conference (1945)

In May 1945, Lord Wavell, the Viceroy of India, went to London and discussed his ideas about the future of India with the British administration. The talks resulted in the formulation of a plan of action that was made public in June 1945. The plan is known as Wavell Plan.

Wavell Plan

- The plan suggested reconstitution of the Viceroy's Executive Council in which the Viceroy was to select persons nominated by the political parties. Different communities were also to get their due share in the council and parity was reserved for Caste-Hindus and Muslims.